SSC MTS 2023 question paper with answers

1 September 2023 · Shift 3

45 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 45 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20231223070914/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_MTS2023_22122023.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 1 question

Q.9

The percentage profit earned by selling an article for ₹1,980 is equal to the percentage loss incurred by selling the same article for ₹1,620. At what price should the article be sold to make a 15% profit?

(A) ₹1,863
(B) ₹2,277
(C) ₹2,070
(D) ₹1,800

General Awareness 20 questions

Q.1

If 7 N force is applied on a brick and it moves through 5 m, then what will be the work done?

(A) 25 J
(B) 40 J
(C) 35 J
(D) 35 Erg

Q.2

_____is celebrated in Jharkhand immediately after Diwali on the new moon day in the honour of cattle.

(A) Bhagta Parab
(B) Makar
(C) Rohini
(D) Sohrai

Q.4

Which of the dance was immediately preceded by a practice session called sevakali and undertaken in the precincts of a temple?

(A) Kathakali
(B) Kathak
(C) Odissi
(D) Kuchipudi

Q.5

Which of the following is a duty of the Attorney General of India?

(A) To give advice to the Government of India on legal matters
(B) To act as a judge in the Supreme Court
(C) To advise the State Government
(D) To represent India in international bodies

Q.6

The cultural heritage of Siddhis from _____ dates back to almost 300 years and their Siddhi Dhamal dance is an exquisite art form.

(A) Uttar Pradesh
(B) Gujarat
(C) Madhya Pradesh
(D) Rajasthan

Q.8

In which of the following cities was the 2023 IPL final match held?

(A) Kolkata
(B) Chennai
(C) Mumbai
(D) Ahmedabad

Q.10

What is a budget deficit?

(A) The excess of government revenue over expenditure
(B) The amount of money allocated for defence spending
(C) The amount of money allocated for social welfare programmes
(D) The excess of government expenditure over revenue

Q.11

What is a revenue expenditure?

(A) Money spent on day-to-day government operations
(B) Money spent on debt repayment
(C) Money spent on purchasing assets
(D) Money spent on construction of roads

Q.13

The holy mountain 'Kailash' is located in which neighbouring country of India?

(A) Pakistan
(B) Afghanistan
(C) Bangladesh
(D) China

Q.14

In which of the following states of India the 'Loo' wind does NOT blow during the summer season?

(A) Punjab
(B) Rajasthan
(C) Goa
(D) Haryana

Q.15

The Wild Life (Protection) Amendment Act, 2022 seeks to implement the Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species of Wild Fauna and Flora (CITES). Which of the following statements is correct about CITES? 1. CITES is an agreement between governments to ensure that international trade in the specimens of wild animals and plants does not threaten the survival of the species. 2. Under CITES, plant and animal specimens are classified into five categories based on the threat to their extinction. 3. The Convention requires countries to regulate the trade of all listed specimens through permits. 4. It also seeks to regulate the possession of live animal specimens.

(A) 1, 2 and 4
(B) 1, 3 and 4
(C) 2, 3 and 4
(D) 1, 2 and 3

Q.16

'My Story' is the autobiography of which female writer?

(A) Amrita Pritam
(B) Pratibha Ray
(C) Kamala Das
(D) Ashapurna Devi

Q.17

Which age group of the population are covered under the Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Grameen Kaushalya Yojana (DDU-GKY) scheme of the Government of India?

(A) 25 to 60 years
(B) 30 to 60 years
(C) 15 to 35 years
(D) 14 to 40 years

Q.18
Who was the founder of Naujawan Bharat Sabha?

(A) Chandra Shekhar Azad
(B) Ajeet Singh
(C) Lala Lajpat Rai
(D) Bhagat Singh

Q.19
Which gland gets enlarged in the goitre due to which there is a swelling in the front part of the throat?

(A) Adrenal gland
(B) Thyroid gland
(C) Pineal gland
(D) Pituitary gland

Q.20
In which state is the Bhitari temple situated?

(A) Uttar Pradesh
(B) Odisha
(C) Jharkhand
(D) Bihar

Q.21
Shubman Gill was in the news for creating a record in his sport. What sport does he play?

(A) Chess
(B) Cricket
(C) Hockey
(D) Badminton

Q.22
Which of the following does NOT come under Fundamental Duties?

(A) To develop the scientific temper
(B) To pay taxes
(C) To promote harmony
(D) To respect National Anthem

Q.24
Which of the following institutions bagged the maximum medals at the third edition of Khelo India University Games?

(A) Panjab University
(B) University of Kerala
(C) Guru Nanak Dev University
(D) Jain University

Q.25
In which year did the All-India Muslim League move a resolution demanding 'Independent States' for Muslims in the north-western and eastern areas of the country?

(A) 1942
(B) 1940
(C) 1939
(D) 1941

English Language and Comprehension 24 questions

Q.1
Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. A soothe voice must convey both confidence and intimacy, qualities which can be attributed to a few key components.

(A) few key components
(B) A soothe voice
(C) convey both confidence
(D) which can be

Q.2
Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Empathetic

(A) Lonely
(B) Merciless
(C) Charismatic
(D) Frustrated

Q.3

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom. The police inspector knows the “ins and outs” of the murder case.

(A) laws
(B) all the witnesses
(C) lawyers and judges
(D) full details

Q.4

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains an error. He told me / that he goes / to the market / to buy a laptop.

(A) He told me
(B) to buy a laptop
(C) to the market
(D) that he goes

Q.5

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined word in the following sentence. The energetic kitten is playful after having “his” breakfast.

(A) its
(B) it’s
(C) it
(D) it is

Q.6

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. It is commonly believed / that Democracy is / the best form / of the government.

(A) of the government
(B) It is commonly believed
(C) that Democracy is
(D) the best form

Q.7

Four words of the following sentence have been underlined and given as options. Select the option that contains a spelling error. Ozone is a “reactiev” gas that is not only important in protecting us from harmful ultraviolet “radiation” but is also a greenhouse gas and, at high smog-level “concentrations”, harmful to human health and “vegetation”.

(A) reactiev
(B) radiation
(C) concentrations
(D) vegetation

Q.9

Parts of the following sentence have been underlined and given as options. Select the option that contains a misspelt word. A “piano” teacher described an “interesting” “encountar” she had with a young lady who came to “inquire” about music lessons.

(A) interesting
(B) inquire
(C) piano
(D) encountar

Q.10

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom. The executives were “running around in circles”, without any success.

(A) Achieving maximum mileage
(B) Suffering huge profits and losses
(C) Successfully accomplishing the target
(D) Putting efforts into something that does not give a worthwhile result

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. Many great people "born" in that small village.

(A) was born
(B) No substitution required
(C) is born
(D) were born

Q.12

The given sentence contains an error. Select the option that correctly rectifies the error. He was carefullest while stealing the crown jewels.

(A) He was more careful while stealing the crown jewels.
(B) He was most carefuller while stealing the crown jewels.
(C) He was carefuller while stealing the crown jewels.
(D) He was most careful while stealing the crown jewels.

Q.13

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Hesitate

(A) Blabber
(B) Recoil
(C) Conceal
(D) Falter

Q.14

The sentence given below has spelling errors. Select the sentence without spelling errors. We can also contribute to presarvation of water bodies by not dumping our garbage in them.

(A) We can also contribute to presarvation of water bodies by not dumpeing our garbage in them.
(B) We can also contribute to preservation of water bodies by not dumping our garbage in them.
(C) We can also contribut to presarvation of water bodies by not dumping our garbage in them.
(D) We can also contribute to presarvation of water bodies by not dumping our garbag in them.

Q.15

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Call it a day

(A) To have the greatest day ever
(B) To stop working
(C) To be very straightforward
(D) To refer to something as something else

Q.16

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Stern

(A) Stable
(B) Sincere
(C) Profound
(D) Lenient

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. His older brothers were quite willing that he should "went to" sea.

(A) had go to
(B) have gone in
(C) gone to
(D) go to

Q.18

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No improvement required'. It is true that learning English is essential for professionals "to survived" the national and international competitions.

(A) to be survive
(B) having to survive
(C) No improvement required
(D) for surviving

Q.19

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The tigress that was killed by the villagers was not only a man-eater, _____ a mother.

(A) but
(B) but also
(C) and
(D) but often

Q.20

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Spill the beans

(A) Excellent health
(B) Behave or speak in a rash manner
(C) Things always get worse
(D) To reveal a secret information unintentionally

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Photosynthesis is the _____(1) used by plants, algae and some bacteria to turn sunlight into energy. The process chemically _____(2) carbon dioxide and water into food and oxygen. The chemical reaction often _____(3) on a pigment called chlorophyll, which gives plants their green colour. Photosynthesis is also the _____(4) our planet is blanketed in an oxygen-rich atmosphere. Plants absorb carbon dioxide from the _____(5) air and release water and oxygen via microscopic pores on their leaves called stomata.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) process
(B) guess
(C) chaos
(D) area

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Photosynthesis is the _____(1) used by plants, algae and some bacteria to turn sunlight into energy. The process chemically _____(2) carbon dioxide and water into food and oxygen. The chemical reaction often _____(3) on a pigment called chlorophyll, which gives plants their green colour. Photosynthesis is also the _____(4) our planet is blanketed in an oxygen-rich atmosphere. Plants absorb carbon dioxide from the _____(5) air and release water and oxygen via microscopic pores on their leaves called stomata.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) converts
(B) exceeds
(C) crates
(D) bows

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Photosynthesis is the _____(1) used by plants, algae and some bacteria to turn sunlight into energy. The process chemically _____(2) carbon dioxide and water into food and oxygen. The chemical reaction often _____(3) on a pigment called chlorophyll, which gives plants their green colour. Photosynthesis is also the _____(4) our planet is blanketed in an oxygen-rich atmosphere. Plants absorb carbon dioxide from the _____(5) air and release water and oxygen via microscopic pores on their leaves called stomata.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) relies
(B) creates
(C) hopes
(D) wants

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Photosynthesis is the _____(1) used by plants, algae and some bacteria to turn sunlight into energy. The process chemically _____(2) carbon dioxide and water into food and oxygen. The chemical reaction often _____(3) on a pigment called chlorophyll, which gives plants their green colour. Photosynthesis is also the _____(4) our planet is blanketed in an oxygen-rich atmosphere. Plants absorb carbon dioxide from the _____(5) air and release water and oxygen via microscopic pores on their leaves called stomata.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) goal
(B) sense
(C) reason
(D) occasion

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Photosynthesis is the _____(1) used by plants, algae and some bacteria to turn sunlight into energy. The process chemically _____(2) carbon dioxide and water into food and oxygen. The chemical reaction often _____(3) on a pigment called chlorophyll, which gives plants their green colour. Photosynthesis is also the _____(4) our planet is blanketed in an oxygen-rich atmosphere. Plants absorb carbon dioxide from the _____(5) air and release water and oxygen via microscopic pores on their leaves called stomata.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) afar
(B) distant
(C) surrounding
(D) close

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.9 **(C)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.8 **(D)**
Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(C)**
Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(B)**
Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(B)**				

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(D)**
Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(B)**
Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(C)**

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.9 · Answer (C) ₹2,070

Equal profit and loss percentages put the cost price midway: (1,980 + 1,620)/2 = ₹1,800. A 15% profit needs 1.15 × 1,800 = ₹2,070.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) 35 J

Work = force × displacement = 7 N × 5 m = 35 J; the SI unit of work is the joule, not the erg.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Sohrai

Sohrai, a harvest festival of Jharkhand's tribal communities, falls at Diwali time in the month of Kartik: cattle are bathed, decorated and worshipped, and houses are painted with Sohrai murals.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Kathakali

SSC's key gives Kathakali, Kerala's dance-drama: IGNOU's course text on Indian dance says its stage presentation was traditionally preceded by a practice session called sevakali, held in the precincts of a temple. (We could not find the term in other sources.)

Q.5 · Answer (A) To give advice to the Government of India on legal matters

Under Article 76 the Attorney General advises the Government of India on legal matters referred by the President and performs other legal duties assigned; a state has its own Advocate General.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Gujarat

The Siddis, a community of East African descent, live in Gujarat chiefly around the Gir forest; their Dhamal, also called Goma, is danced to drums.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Ahmedabad

The 2023 IPL final was played at the Narendra Modi Stadium, Ahmedabad, on 29 May 2023 (a reserve day, after rain on the 28th); Chennai Super Kings beat Gujarat Titans.

Q.10 · Answer (D) The excess of government expenditure over revenue

A budget deficit is the amount by which the government's expenditure exceeds its receipts; a surplus is the reverse.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Money spent on day-to-day government operations

Revenue expenditure creates no assets and reduces no liabilities: salaries, subsidies, interest and other day-to-day running costs. Repaying loans, buying assets and building roads are capital expenditure.

Q.13 · Answer (D) China

Mount Kailash, sacred to Hindus, Buddhists, Jains and followers of Bon, stands in the Tibet Autonomous Region of China, near Lake Manasarovar.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Goa

The Loo is the hot, dry wind of May and June over the plains of north and north-west India, including Punjab, Haryana and Rajasthan. Goa, on the west coast, has a humid climate tempered by the sea.

Q.15 · Answer (B) 1, 3 and 4

CITES sorts species into three Appendices by how threatened they are, not five, so statement 2 is wrong. It is an agreement between governments, trade in listed specimens needs permits, and the 2022 Act also regulates the possession of live specimens: 1, 3 and 4.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Kamala Das

'My Story' is the autobiography of Kamala Das (Madhavikutty), who wrote in English and Malayalam; the Malayalam version is 'Ente Katha'.

Q.17 · Answer (C) 15 to 35 years
DDU-GKY, the Ministry of Rural Development's placement-linked skilling scheme, is for poor rural youth aged 15 to 35 (up to 45 for women and some other groups).

Q.18 · Answer (D) Bhagat Singh
Bhagat Singh founded the Naujawan Bharat Sabha at Lahore in March 1926 to rally young people, workers and peasants against British rule.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Thyroid gland
A goitre is an enlarged thyroid gland, which sits in the front of the neck; the commonest cause is too little iodine in the diet.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Uttar Pradesh
Bhitari, in Ghazipur district of Uttar Pradesh, is a Gupta-period site known for Skandagupta's pillar inscription; the Gupta brick temple at Bhitargaon, near Kanpur, is also in Uttar Pradesh.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Cricket
Shubman Gill is an Indian cricketer. In January 2023 his 208 against New Zealand at Hyderabad made him the youngest batter to score a double century in one-day internationals.

Q.22 · Answer (B) To pay taxes
The Fundamental Duties in Article 51A include respecting the National Anthem, promoting harmony and developing the scientific temper, but not paying taxes.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Panjab University
Panjab University, Chandigarh, topped the medal table at the third Khelo India University Games, held in Uttar Pradesh in May-June 2023, with 69 medals (26 gold); Guru Nanak Dev University was second with 68.

Q.25 · Answer (B) 1940
The Lahore Resolution, adopted at the Muslim League's Lahore session in March 1940, asked for 'Independent States' in the Muslim-majority north-western and eastern zones.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (B) A soothe voice
'Soothe' is a verb; the noun 'voice' needs the adjective: 'A soothing voice'.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Merciless
'Empathetic' means able to share another's feelings; 'merciless', without pity, is its opposite.

Q.3 · Answer (D) full details
The 'ins and outs' of something are all its details.

Q.4 · Answer (D) that he goes
After a past reporting verb the reported verb moves back to the past: 'He told me that he went to the market to buy a laptop.'

Q.5 · Answer (A) its
An animal of unstated sex is 'it', and its possessive is 'its', with no apostrophe; 'it's' means 'it is'.

Q.6 · Answer (A) of the government
'Government' in the general sense, a system of rule, takes no article: 'the best form of government'.

Q.7 · Answer (A) reactiev
The correct spelling is 'reactive'.

Q.9 · Answer (D) encountar
The correct spelling is 'encounter'.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Putting efforts into something that does not give a worthwhile result
To 'run around in circles' is to work hard without getting anywhere.

Q.11 · Answer (D) were born
The sentence needs a passive verb, plural to agree with 'people': 'Many great people were born in that small village.'

Q.12 · Answer (D) He was most careful while stealing the crown jewels.
'Careful' forms its superlative with 'most', not '-est': 'He was most careful'. 'Carefuller' is not standard, 'most carefuller' doubles the comparison, and 'more careful' turns the superlative into a comparative.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Falter
To 'hesitate' is to pause in uncertainty: to 'falter'.

Q.14 · Answer (B) We can also contribute to preservation of water bodies by not dumping our garbage in them.
Only the second sentence spells 'contribute', 'preservation', 'dumping' and 'garbage' correctly.

Q.15 · Answer (B) To stop working
To 'call it a day' is to stop working, for the day or for good.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Lenient
'Stern' means strict and severe; its opposite is 'lenient'.

Q.17 · Answer (D) go to
A modal such as 'should' takes the base form of the verb: 'that he should go to sea'.

Q.18 · Answer (D) for surviving
SSC's key gives 'for surviving', which keeps the sense of purpose: English is essential for surviving the competitions. 'To survived' is wrong because 'to' takes the base form, and the plain correction 'to survive' is not offered; 'to be survive' is ungrammatical, and 'having to survive' would describe the professionals instead of giving the purpose.

Q.19 · Answer (B) but also
'Not only' pairs with 'but also': 'not only a man-eater, but also a mother'.

Q.20 · Answer (D) To reveal a secret information unintentionally
To 'spill the beans' is to let out a secret, often carelessly or too soon.

Q.21 · Answer (A) process
Photosynthesis is the 'process' by which plants turn sunlight into energy; the next sentence goes on with 'The process'.

Q.22 · Answer (A) converts
To 'convert' one thing into another is to change it: carbon dioxide and water are changed into food and oxygen.

Q.23 · Answer (A) relies
The reaction 'relies on' chlorophyll, that is, depends on it.

Q.24 · Answer (C) reason
Photosynthesis is the 'reason' the atmosphere is rich in oxygen: the cause of it.

Q.25 · Answer (C) surrounding
Plants take carbon dioxide from the 'surrounding' air, the air around them; 'afar' and 'distant' contradict this.

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